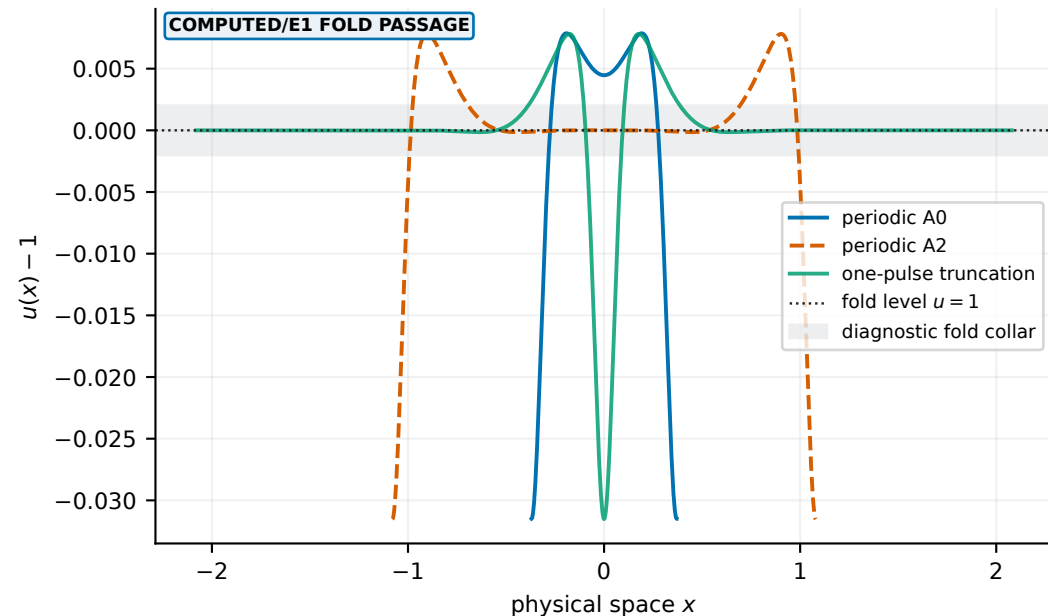
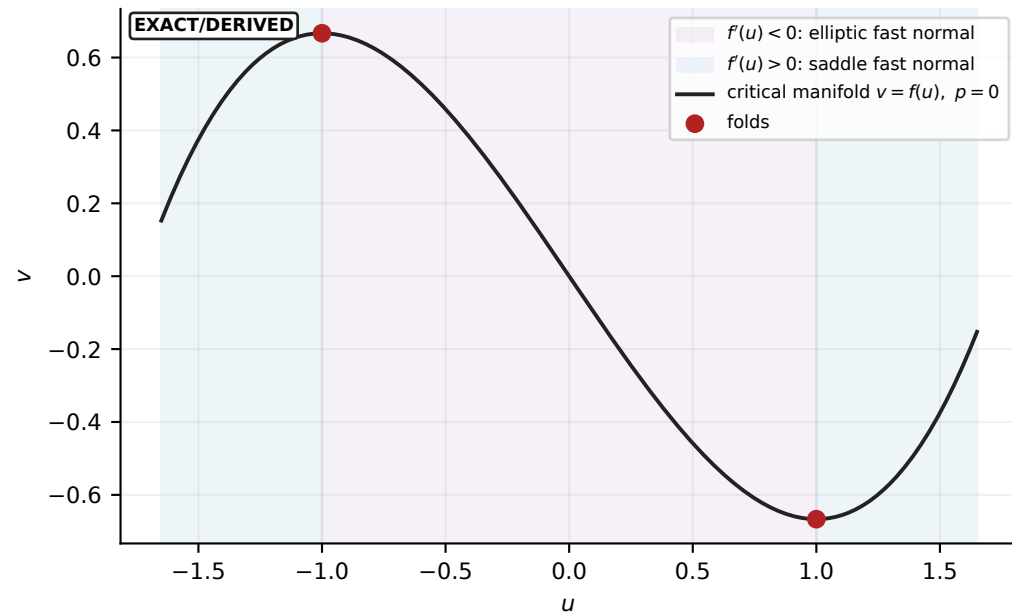


Slow--fast geometry — fold passage and FSN-II degeneracy are not a maximal canard

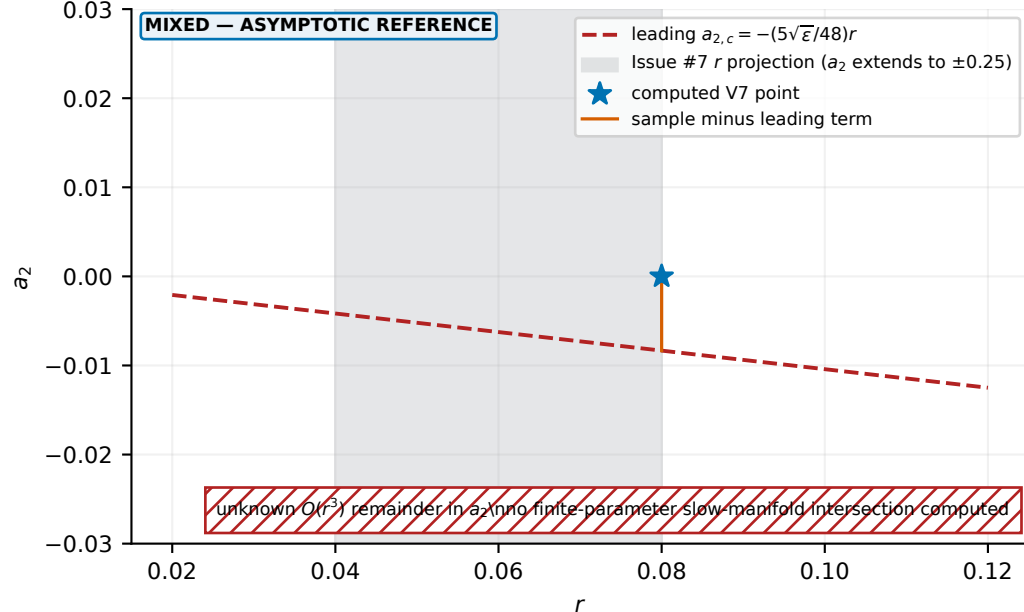
(a) finite profiles cross the positive fold level



(b) exact singular critical-manifold geometry



(c) leading maximal-canard curve is a reference, not an enclosure



(d) evidence ladder and mandatory stop rule

NO CANARD IDENTIFICATION		
1	critical manifold and folds	EXACT
2	saved profiles meet both fast-normal sides	COMPUTED
3	current singular reduced point	FSN-II DEGENERATE
4	published maximal-canard curve	LEADING TERM ONLY
5	finite-parameter slow-manifold intersection	NOT COMPUTED
STOP	canard identification	NO CANARD IDENTIFICATION
saved outer leg: $u \in [5.0, 14.1]$; it stays at least 4.0 from either fold		